Contradiction Memo

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When looking over our interviews for boxing, piano, jewelry making, and golf, we found some clear contradictions in how people practice their hobbies that directly challenged our team's initial assumptions. As computer science students working on a project management assignment, spotting these differences early is super helpful because it keeps us from building features people do not actually want based on flawed guesses.

The first major tension is between wanting privacy and wanting to share. While we did take user preferences in sharing into consideration during our initial assumptions, it was through these interviews that we realized just how crucial a well-thought-out approach is, especially after seeing the contradiction in *how* users wanted to share. In our piano and jewelry interview, the user likes to keep things totally private to avoid pressure, while also admitting that getting feedback from others helps them improve. Similarly, our boxing user likes to "gatekeep" gym locations to keep crowds small, even though they still enjoy working out in group settings. To fix this, our app needs flexible privacy settings so users can easily choose what stays completely private, what goes to a small group of friends or family, what gets reviewed by professionals without bothering anyone else, and what gets shared publicly.

The second tension is about how people track their progress. We originally assumed users just wanted numbers, stats and in general way to track progress would help them keep working towards their goal, but our research showed that is not always true. Our boxing user does not care about step counters or digital metrics and instead relies entirely on physical feel and endurance. Meanwhile, our golf user uses apps for scores, but when they want to fix their swing, numbers do not help, they have to watch and compare video recordings instead. This taught us that raw stats only show the final score, not how to actually fix your technique. To solve this, SkillUp should act as a flexible hub where users can save photo and video galleries, take notes, and compare past performances side-by-side. In other words, its customization settings and expandability need to be well-designed to allow this flexibility to flourish and adapt to any user preference.

Finally, we saw a split between how people prefer to learn versus how they actually find resources. We assumed a single learning pathway would work, but for boxing, the user strongly prefers hands-on, in-person training while still using YouTube tutorials when they need a quick fix like learning how to wrap their hands. For golf, the user really wants professional lessons but cannot fit them into their schedule. This proves that learning styles are totally different for everyone. Letting users access professional lessons inside SkillUp is a great option, but more importantly, it shows why our app's portfolio customization needs to be as adaptable as possible so it can fit any learning style.